

STUDY-UNI · UCC MARKING SCHEME

MA1100

Introductory Mathematics for Business I

Full Model Answers & Mark Allocation

Examination Session: Summer 2024 · **Paper:** 1

Module Code: MA1100 · **Duration:** 1.5 hours

Instructions to Candidates: Answer Question 1 and two other questions.

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Question 1

Total: 30 marks

(a) [5 marks]

€20,000 is invested at a rate of 5% per annum compounded yearly. What is the value of the investment after 25 years?

FULL MODEL ANSWER

Apply the compound interest formula $A = P(1 + r)^t$ with $P = €20,000$, $r = 0.05$, $t = 25$:

$$A = 20\{, \}000 \times (1.05)^{25}$$

$$A = €67,727.10 \text{ (to the nearest cent)}$$

Mark Allocation — (a)

Tier	Marks	Criteria
Full credit	5	Correct formula with correct substitution AND correct final value €67,727.10 (± €0.01).
Good	3	Correct formula and substitution, minor rounding/calculator slip in the final figure.
Partial	2	Correct formula stated with correct values identified (P, r, t) but not correctly evaluated.
Minimal	0	Incorrect formula (e.g. simple interest) or no coherent attempt.

(b) [5 marks]

Calculate the monthly repayments on a loan of €50,000 borrowed at a rate of 3.6% per annum over 8 years.

FULL MODEL ANSWER

Use the present value annuity formula $V_0 = A_0[1 - (1+i)^{-n}] / i$, and solve for the monthly repayment A_0 . Here $V_0 = €50,000$, monthly rate $i = 0.036/12 = 0.003$, and $n = 8 \times 12 = 96$ months:

$$A_0 = V_0 \times i / [1 - (1+i)^{-n}] = 50,000 \times 0.003 / [1 - (1.003)^{-96}]$$

$$A_0 = €600.20 \text{ per month (to the nearest cent)}$$

Checknote: This is the mirror image of the mortgage-term problems elsewhere on this paper: here n and i are known and A_0 is the unknown, so the present value formula must be rearranged rather than solved directly.

Mark Allocation — (b)

Tier	Marks	Criteria
Full credit	5	Correctly identifies $V_0 = 50,000$, $i = 0.003$, $n = 96$ AND rearranges the present value annuity formula for A_0 AND reaches €600.20.
Good	3	Correct formula and correct i , n , with a slip in the final evaluation.
Partial	2	Correct formula identified but incorrect conversion of the annual rate/term to monthly (e.g. using $n = 8$ instead of 96).
Minimal	0	Wrong formula used (e.g. future value formula instead of present value), or no coherent attempt.

(c)(i) [2 marks]

Calculate the Annual Percentage Rate (APR) for an interest rate of 4% compounded monthly, to 4 decimal places.

FULL MODEL ANSWER

APR = $(1 + r/m)^m - 1$, with $r = 0.04$, $m = 12$:

$$\text{APR} = (1 + 0.04/12)^{12} - 1$$

$$\text{APR} = 4.0742\%$$

Mark Allocation — (c)(i)

Tier	Marks	Criteria
Full credit	2	Correct formula, correct substitution, AND APR = 4.0742% to 4dp.
Minimal	0	Incorrect or missing formula.

(c)(ii) [1 marks]

Calculate the Annual Percentage Rate (APR) for an interest rate of 4% compounded continuously, to 4 decimal places.

FULL MODEL ANSWER

For continuous compounding, $APR = e^r - 1$, with $r = 0.04$:

$$APR = e^{0.04} - 1$$

$$APR = 4.0811\%$$

Checknote: As in every APR-comparison question on this paper: continuous compounding always gives the highest APR for a given nominal rate — a fast self-check between (c)(i) and (c)(ii).

Mark Allocation — (c)(ii)

Tier	Marks	Criteria
Full credit	1	Correct continuous-compounding formula AND APR = 4.0811% to 4dp.
Minimal	0	Uses the discrete-compounding formula instead of e^r , or no coherent attempt.

(d)(i) [2 marks]

Find the derivative of $f(x) = 4x^3 + 7x + \sqrt{x}$ and write your answer in its simplest form.

FULL MODEL ANSWER

Differentiate term by term, writing $\sqrt{x}$ as $x^{1/2}$:

$$f(x) = 4x^3 + 7x + x^{1/2}$$

$$f'(x) = 12x^2 + 7 + 1/(2\sqrt{x})$$

Mark Allocation — (d)(i)

Tier	Marks	Criteria
Full credit	2	Correct power-rule differentiation of all three terms AND simplified final answer.
Partial	1	Correct differentiation of two of the three terms.
Minimal	0	Incorrect application of the power rule.

(d)(ii) [2 marks]

Find the derivative of $f(x) = x(\ln x - 1)$ and write your answer in its simplest form.

FULL MODEL ANSWER

Apply the **product rule**, $u = x$, $v = (\ln x - 1)$, so $u' = 1$, $v' = 1/x$:

$$f'(x) = 1 \cdot (\ln x - 1) + x \cdot (1/x) = (\ln x - 1) + 1$$

$$f'(x) = \ln x$$

Mark Allocation — (d)(ii)

Tier	Marks	Criteria
Full credit	2	Correct product rule setup AND simplifies fully to $\ln x$.
Partial	1	Correct product rule setup but does not simplify to $\ln x$.
Minimal	0	Product rule not applied, or incorrect derivative of $\ln x$.

(d)(iii) [2 marks]

Find the derivative of $f(x) = (x^2 - 1)/(x - 1)$ and write your answer in its simplest form.

FULL MODEL ANSWER

Rather than applying the quotient rule directly, notice the numerator factorises: $x^2 - 1 = (x-1)(x+1)$. For $x \neq 1$, the function simplifies first:

$$f(x) = (x-1)(x+1) / (x-1) = x + 1$$

This is now trivial to differentiate:

$$f'(x) = 1$$

Checknote: Spotting that x^2-1 factorises as $(x-1)(x+1)$ turns this into a one-line derivative — always check whether a rational function simplifies before reaching for the quotient rule.

Mark Allocation — (d)(iii)

Tier	Marks	Criteria
Full credit	2	Recognises the difference-of-squares factorisation, simplifies $f(x)$ to $x+1$ AND correctly states $f'(x) = 1$.
Good	1	Applies the quotient rule directly without simplifying first and reaches an equivalent correct expression that simplifies to 1.
Minimal	0	Neither the simplification route nor a correctly applied quotient rule is present.

(d)(iv) [3 marks]

Find the derivative of $f(x) = 1/\sqrt{x+1}$ and write your answer in its simplest form.

FULL MODEL ANSWER

Write as a power and apply the **chain rule**:

$$f(x) = (x+1)^{-1/2}$$

$$f'(x) = -(1/2)(x+1)^{-3/2} \times 1$$

$$f'(x) = -1 / [2(x+1)^{3/2}]$$

Mark Allocation — (d)(iv)

Tier	Marks	Criteria
Full credit	3	Correctly rewrites as a negative power AND correct chain rule application AND correctly simplified final form.
Good	2	Correct chain rule application with an index-law slip in the final simplification.
Partial	1	Correct power rewritten but chain rule (inner derivative) omitted.
Minimal	0	No coherent differentiation attempt.

(e) [8 marks]

Using implicit differentiation, find dy/dx for $x^2 + y^2 - 6x - 6y + 10 = 0$. Given that $a = (5,1)$ is a point on the graph, find the slope of the tangent line at the point a . Hence, find the equation of the tangent line at the point a .

FULL MODEL ANSWER

Differentiate every term with respect to x , treating y as a function of x (y^2 needs the **chain rule**):

$$2x + 2y(dy/dx) - 6 - 6(dy/dx) = 0$$

Collect the dy/dx terms on one side:

$$(dy/dx)(2y - 6) = 6 - 2x$$

$$dy/dx = (6 - 2x) / (2y - 6) = (3 - x) / (y - 3)$$

Slope at $a(5,1)$: substitute $x = 5$, $y = 1$:

$$dy/dx = (3 - 5) / (1 - 3) = (-2) / (-2)$$

$$\text{slope} = 1$$

Tangent line at $a(5,1)$: use point-slope form $y - y_1 = m(x - x_1)$:

$$y - 1 = 1(x - 5)$$

$$y = x - 4$$

Checknote: This equation describes a circle — $(x-3)^2 + (y-3)^2 = 8$ — so the tangent line at $(5,1)$ can be sanity-checked by confirming it is perpendicular to the radius from the centre $(3,3)$ to $(5,1)$, which has slope -1 , matching a tangent slope of 1 .

Mark Allocation — (e)

Tier	Marks	Criteria
Full credit	8	Correct implicit differentiation of all terms (chain rule on y^2) AND correct general dy/dx AND correct slope at a ($= 1$) AND correct tangent line equation.
Good	6	Correct dy/dx and correct slope at a , but an error in forming or simplifying the final tangent line equation.
Partial	4	Correct differentiation of each term individually but an error collecting dy/dx terms, so the general dy/dx expression is wrong — slope and tangent line follow through correctly from the student's own (incorrect) expression.
Minimal	1	Chain rule omitted on y^2 (treated as if y were a constant).

Question 1 — Total

30/30 marks confirmed

Question 2

Total: 25 marks

(a) [5 marks]

The supply function is $P_s = (1/4)Q + 3/2$ and the demand function is $P_d = 15 - (1/8)Q$. If P is on the vertical axis and Q is on the horizontal axis, write down the slope of the supply function and the slope of the demand function.

FULL MODEL ANSWER

Both functions are already written as $P = (\text{slope}) \cdot Q + \text{intercept}$, so the slopes read off directly:

Function	Equation	Slope (dP/dQ)
Supply	$P_s = (1/4)Q + 3/2$	1/4
Demand	$P_d = 15 - (1/8)Q$	-1/8

Mark Allocation — (a)

Tier	Marks	Criteria
Full credit	5	Both slopes correctly identified: supply = 1/4, demand = -1/8, with correct sign on the demand slope.
Partial	3	One slope correct, or both magnitudes correct but the negative sign on demand omitted.
Minimal	0	Slopes not correctly extracted from the given equations.

(b) [6 marks]

Determine the equilibrium price and quantity.

FULL MODEL ANSWER

At equilibrium, $P_s = P_d$:

$$(1/4)Q + 3/2 = 15 - (1/8)Q$$

$$(3/8)Q = 27/2 \Rightarrow Q = 36$$

Substitute back into either equation to find P:

$$P = (1/4)(36) + 3/2 = 9 + 1.5$$

EQUILIBRIUM

$$Q^* = 36, P^* = €10.50$$

Mark Allocation — (b)

Tier	Marks	Criteria
Full credit	6	Correctly sets $P_s = P_d$, solves for $Q = 36$ AND $P = €10.50$, with both values stated clearly.
Good	4	Correct method and correct Q, with an arithmetic slip carried into the final P value (or vice versa).
Partial	2	Correct equation set up ($P_s = P_d$) but not solved through to numeric values.
Minimal	0	Incorrect equilibrium condition used.

(c) [8 marks]

If a tax of €4.50 is added on the sale of each item, what will the new equilibrium price and quantity be?

FULL MODEL ANSWER

A per-unit tax raises the price sellers must receive to be willing to supply any given quantity — it shifts the supply curve **up** by the amount of the tax:

$$P_{s(\text{new})} = (1/4)Q + 3/2 + 4.5 = (1/4)Q + 6$$

Set the new supply curve equal to the (unchanged) demand curve:

$$(1/4)Q + 6 = 15 - (1/8)Q$$

$$(3/8)Q = 9 \Rightarrow Q = 24$$

Substitute into the demand curve to get the price consumers pay:

$$P = 15 - (1/8)(24) = 15 - 3 = 12$$

$$\text{New } Q^* = 24, \text{ new price paid by consumers} = \text{€}12.00$$

The price producers actually *keep* per unit, net of the tax, is this consumer price minus the €4.50 tax: €12.00 – €4.50 = **€7.50** — this figure is needed for part (d).

Checknote: A tax pushes the supply curve up (sellers need more per unit to break even after remitting the tax) — the opposite direction to a subsidy, which pushes it down.

Mark Allocation — (c)

Tier	Marks	Criteria
Full credit	8	Correctly shifts the supply curve up by €4.50 AND solves the new equilibrium AND correctly reports Q = 24, consumer price = €12.00 (with producer's net price identified as €7.50).
Good	6	Correct direction of shift and correct new equilibrium Q and consumer price, but the distinction between consumer price and producer's net price not drawn out.
Partial	3	Correctly identifies that supply shifts by €4.50 but shifts it the wrong direction (down instead of up), carrying through consistently.
Minimal	0	Tax applied to the demand curve instead of supply, or no shift applied at all.

(d) [6 marks]

In what ratio will the tax be shared between the producer and the consumer?

FULL MODEL ANSWER

Compare each side's price before and after the tax (using the original equilibrium price €10.50 from part (b) as the baseline):

Party	Price before	Price after	Burden
Consumer pays	€10.50	€12.00	€1.50
Producer receives (net)	€10.50	€7.50	€3.00
Total (must equal the €4.50 tax)			€4.50

Expressing the burdens as a ratio, producer : consumer:

$$3.00 : 1.50 \equiv 2 : 1$$

The producer bears twice the burden of the consumer here. This follows from the relative slopes in part (a): supply is flatter (more elastic, $|\text{slope}| = 1/4$) than demand (less elastic, $|\text{slope}| = 1/8$) — the flatter (more elastic) side of the market bears the *larger* share of a tax, since it is less able to simply absorb the price change by adjusting quantity as freely as the steeper side.

Checknote: Note the ratio direction is reversed compared with a market where demand is the flatter curve — always re-derive from the actual slopes rather than assuming which side 'always' bears more.

Mark Allocation — (d)

Tier	Marks	Criteria
Full credit	6	Correctly computes both the consumer price rise (€1.50) and producer price fall (€3.00), AND confirms they sum to €4.50, AND states the ratio 2:1 (producer:consumer).
Good	4	Correct ratio 2:1 obtained, without explicit reference to the sum-to-€4.50 check or the elasticity explanation.
Partial	2	One of the two burden amounts (consumer rise or producer fall) correctly computed, but the ratio not correctly formed.
Minimal	0	No coherent attempt to split the €4.50 tax between the two parties.

Question 2 — Total

25/25 marks confirmed

Question 3

Total: 25 marks

(a) [8 marks]

A couple requires €50,000 in 18 years' time, when their child starts college. They decide to invest €150 every month for 18 years at 4.8% per annum compounded monthly. What will be the value of the investment at the end of the 18 years?

FULL MODEL ANSWER

Use the future value annuity formula $V_n = A_0[(1+i)^n - 1] / i$, with the monthly deposit $A_0 = €150$, monthly rate $i = 0.048/12 = 0.004$, and $n = 18 \times 12 = 216$ months:

$$V_{216} = 150 \times [(1.004)^{216} - 1] / 0.004$$

$$V_{216} = €51,320.50 \text{ (to the nearest cent)}$$

Mark Allocation — (a)

Tier	Marks	Criteria
Full credit	8	Correctly identifies $A_0 = 150$, $i = 0.004$, $n = 216$ AND applies the future value annuity formula correctly AND reaches €51,320.50.
Good	6	Correct formula and correct i , n , but a slip in the final evaluation.
Partial	4	Correct formula identified but incorrect conversion of the annual rate/term to monthly (e.g. using $n = 18$ instead of 216).
Minimal	1	Wrong formula used (e.g. present value formula, or simple compound interest with no annuity structure).

(b) [8 marks]

The couple win a local lottery and decide they would prefer to invest a lump sum now instead of saving monthly. How much would they need to invest in the same account to have €50,000 in 18 years' time? How much would they save by doing this?

FULL MODEL ANSWER

Lump sum required: discount the target €50,000 back to today at the same monthly rate $i = 0.004$ over $n = 216$ months:

$$V_0 = 50\{, \}000 / (1.004)^{216}$$

$$V_0 = \text{€}21,109.99 \text{ (to the nearest cent)}$$

Savings: compare this lump sum to the total cash the couple would otherwise pay in via monthly deposits (150×216 months):

$$\text{Total monthly contributions} = 150 \times 216 = \text{€}32,400.00$$

$$\text{Savings} = 32\{, \}400.00 - 21\{, \}109.99$$

$$\text{Savings} = \text{€}11,290.01$$

Checknote: The 'saving' here is about total cash paid out of pocket, not investment return — it's the gap between what the couple hands over as monthly deposits versus as a single lump sum, since the lump sum benefits from a full 18 years of compounding on the whole amount immediately.

Mark Allocation — (b)

Tier	Marks	Criteria
Full credit	8	Correctly discounts €50,000 back to a lump sum of €21,109.99 AND correctly compares it to total monthly contributions of €32,400 AND reaches savings of €11,290.01.
Good	6	Correct lump sum value found, but the savings comparison uses the wrong benchmark (e.g. compares to the €50,000 target rather than total contributions paid in).
Partial	4	Correct present-value formula and substitution attempted, but not correctly evaluated.
Minimal	1	Future value formula used instead of present value, or no coherent attempt.

(c) [9 marks]

The monthly repayment on a mortgage of €400,000 is €1,410. If the interest rate is 2.4% per annum compounded monthly, how many years does it take to pay off the mortgage?

FULL MODEL ANSWER

Use the present value annuity formula $V_0 = A_0[1 - (1+i)^{-n}] / i$, with $V_0 = €400,000$, $A_0 = €1,410$, $i = 0.024/12 = 0.002$. Solve for n :

$$400,000 = 1,410 \times [1 - (1.002)^{-n}] / 0.002$$

$$1 - (1.002)^{-n} = 400,000 \times 0.002 / 1,410 = 0.56738$$

$$(1.002)^{-n} = 0.43262$$

Take logs of both sides and solve for n :

$$-n \cdot \ln(1.002) = \ln(0.43262) \Rightarrow n = 419.36 \text{ months}$$

$$n \approx 419 \text{ months} \approx 34.9 \text{ years}$$

Checknote: Unlike some mortgage-term questions on other sittings, this one does not resolve to a perfectly round number of years — 34.9 years is the correct answer here, and should not be forced to round to 35 without showing the underlying figure.

Mark Allocation — (c)

Tier	Marks	Criteria
Full credit	9	Correctly sets up the present value annuity formula with the given values AND correctly isolates $(1.002)^{-n}$ AND solves via logs to $n \approx 35$ years.
Good	7	Correct set-up and correct isolation of the exponential term, with a slip in the final log-solving step.
Partial	5	Correct formula identified and correctly substituted, but not successfully rearranged to isolate the exponential term.
Minimal	2	Uses the future value formula instead of present value, or does not attempt to solve for n via logarithms.

Question 3 — Total

25/25 marks confirmed

Question 4

Total: 25 marks

4(a)(i) [5 marks]

A supply function is given by $Q = 40 + 0.1P^2$. Calculate the elasticity equation as a function of P .

FULL MODEL ANSWER

Price elasticity of supply is $E = (dQ/dP) \times (P/Q)$. First differentiate Q with respect to P :

$$dQ/dP = 0.2P$$

Then form the elasticity expression using the original $Q(P)$:

$$E(P) = 0.2P \times P / (40 + 0.1P^2) = 0.2P^2 / (40 + 0.1P^2)$$

Mark Allocation — 4(a)(i)

Tier	Marks	Criteria
Full credit	5	Correctly differentiates Q to get $dQ/dP = 0.2P$ AND correctly forms $E(P) = (dQ/dP)(P/Q)$ with the full expression for Q in the denominator.
Partial	3	Correct dQ/dP but elasticity formula assembled incorrectly (e.g. Q/P used instead of P/Q).
Minimal	0	Incorrect differentiation of Q with respect to P .

4(a)(ii) [5 marks]

Find the price elasticity of supply when the current price is $P = 13$.

FULL MODEL ANSWER

Substitute $P = 13$ into both dQ/dP and Q :

$$dQ/dP = 0.2(13) = 2.6$$

$$Q = 40 + 0.1(13)^2 = 40 + 16.9 = 56.9$$

$$E(13) = 2.6 \times (13 / 56.9)$$

$$E(13) \approx 0.594$$

Checknote: $E(13) < 1$ means supply is inelastic at this price — a useful check against part (iii), since it means the percentage change in Q should come out smaller than the percentage change in P .

Mark Allocation — 4(a)(ii)

Tier	Marks	Criteria
Full credit	5	Correctly substitutes $P = 13$ into both dQ/dP and $Q(P)$ AND reaches $E(13) \approx 0.594$, carried through consistently from the student's own (a)(i) expression.
Good	3	Correct substitution into dQ/dP and Q with an arithmetic slip in the final ratio.
Partial	1	Only one of dQ/dP or Q correctly evaluated at $P = 13$.
Minimal	0	No substitution attempted.

4(a)(iii) [2 marks]

What is the percentage change in supply if the price rises by 2%?

FULL MODEL ANSWER

By definition, $E \approx (\% \Delta Q) / (\% \Delta P)$, so $\% \Delta Q = E \times \% \Delta P$:

$$\% \Delta Q = 0.594 \times 2\%$$

$$\% \Delta Q \approx 1.19\%$$

Mark Allocation — 4(a)(iii)

Tier	Marks	Criteria
Full credit	2	Correctly applies $\% \Delta Q = E \times \% \Delta P$ using the student's own E(13), reaching ≈1.19%.
Minimal	0	Formula not applied, or elasticity from (a)(ii) not correctly carried forward.

4(b)(i) [10 marks]

A company sells Q items at a cost of P per item. The demand function for the items is $P = 200 - 4Q$. The fixed costs function is $FC(Q) = Q^2 + 50Q + 10$. Find the value of Q that maximises the profit and the corresponding price.

FULL MODEL ANSWER

Revenue: $R = P \times Q$, using the demand function to express price in terms of Q :

$$R(Q) = (200 - 4Q)Q = 200Q - 4Q^2$$

Profit = Revenue – Costs. Note the "fixed costs" function here is itself a function of Q — the full cost function — so:

$$\pi(Q) = R(Q) - FC(Q) = (200Q - 4Q^2) - (Q^2 + 50Q + 10)$$

$$\pi(Q) = -5Q^2 + 150Q - 10$$

Maximise by setting the first derivative to zero:

$$d\pi/dQ = -10Q + 150 = 0 \Rightarrow Q = 15$$

Check the second derivative: $d^2\pi/dQ^2 = -10 < 0$, confirming a **maximum**.

CONFIRMED MAXIMUM

Corresponding price, from the demand function:

$$P = 200 - 4(15) = 200 - 60$$

$$Q^* = 15 \text{ units, } P^* = \text{€}140$$

Checknote: The label 'fixed costs function' is a deliberate misnomer in this question — $FC(Q)$ here still depends on Q , so it must be subtracted as a full function, not treated as a constant the way a genuinely fixed cost would be.

Mark Allocation — 4(b)(i)

Tier	Marks	Criteria
Full credit	10	Correctly forms revenue from the demand function AND correctly forms profit as $R - FC$ AND sets $d\pi/dQ = 0$ to get $Q = 15$ AND verifies it is a maximum via the second derivative AND correctly finds $P = \text{€}140$.
Good	7	Correct profit function and correct $Q = 15$, but the second-derivative maximum check or the final price is missing.
Partial	4	Correct revenue function formed, but $FC(Q)$ subtracted incorrectly (e.g. treated as a constant rather than a function of Q).
Minimal	1	Profit not correctly formed as revenue minus cost.

4(b)(ii) [3 marks]

Find the total profit for this level of production.

FULL MODEL ANSWER

Substitute $Q = 15$ into the profit function derived in (b)(i):

$$\pi(15) = -5(15)^2 + 150(15) - 10 = -1\{,\}125 + 2\{,\}250 - 10$$

$$\pi(15) = \text{€}1,115$$

Mark Allocation — 4(b)(ii)

Tier	Marks	Criteria
Full credit	3	Correctly substitutes $Q = 15$ into the profit function from (b)(i) AND reaches €1,115, carried through consistently from the student's own (b)(i) profit function.
Partial	1	Correct substitution method but an arithmetic slip in the final value.
Minimal	0	Incorrect or missing substitution.

Question 4 — Total

25/25 marks confirmed